Some of the carbohydrates are immediately utilized by the tissues and the remaining is stored as glycogen in the liver and muscles and some are stored as adipose tissues for future energy needs.

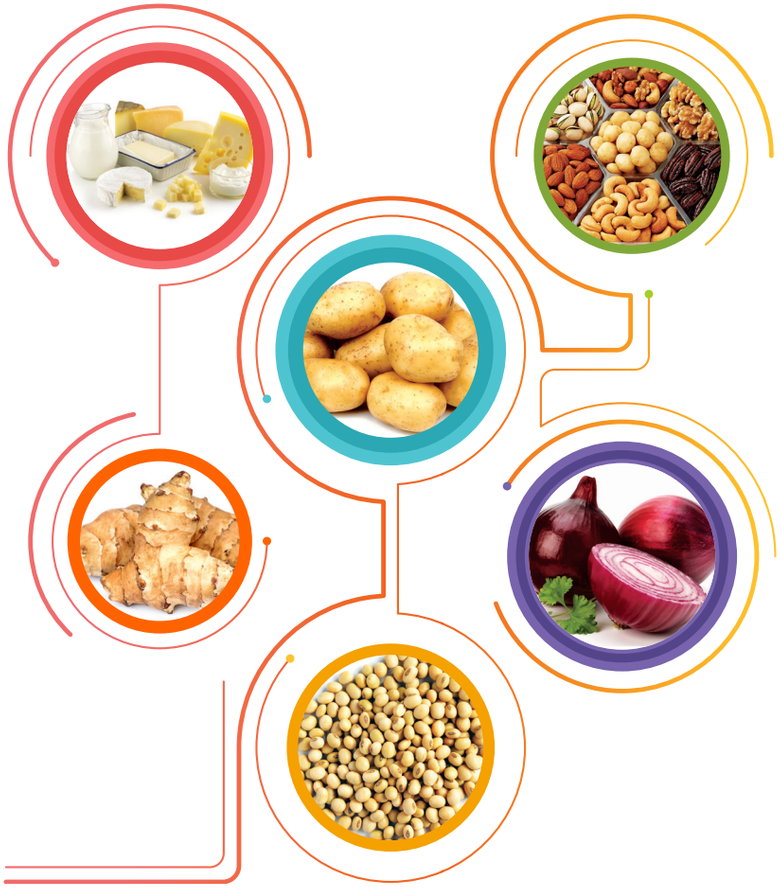


Figure 5.1 Foods rich in carbohydrate

ii. Protein-sparing action:

Carbohydrates are mainly utilized by the body of fulfilling the major part of the energy needs, thus sparing protein for tissue building and repairing. The first physiological demand of the body is the need for energy, which must be satisfied before the nutrients are used for other functions. So, this function of carbohydrates is to spare protein for its body building and repair of tissues.

iii. Essential for Fat Oxidation:

Even though fat yields twice as much as energy as carbohydrate for unit weight, carbohydrate is essential for oxidation of fats. The common expression that 'fat burns in the fire of carbohydrates' is used to emphasize that in absence of carbohydrates, fats cannot be oxidised by the body to yield energy. A breakdown product of carbohydrate is essential for the oxidation of acetate, which is the breakdown product of fats.

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